

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Mona Lott

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS

**Mona Lott**

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## *International Cultural Heritage Envoy*

Mona can turn a disagreement about a bowl into an international summit. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural' while bringing three lawyers.

- Long-running professional friendship and rivalry with **Sue Venir**.
- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Robin Banks** on how restitution should actually work.
- **Artie Ficial** has courted her support for several international partnerships.

## ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent canapé.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# INTRODUCTIONS

Mona Lott

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

### Your other secret

You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

### Conversations to start

- Find out whether Paige Turner knows you were the leak.
- Get Sue Venir to acknowledge that the legal risk is real.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.*

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## HUNT FOR CLUES

Mona Lott

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# The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*
- 2 *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*
- 3 *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## ACT I: MOTIVE

**Mona Lott**

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT I: MOTIVE

Mona Lott

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

An announcement is not an agreement. Grant intended to make the Star Bowl a permanent Meridian holding. That would destroy months of restitution negotiations and humiliate the international partners I represent. He wanted an announcement before anybody could challenge his claim. I wanted him to stop.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

**Mona Lott**

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Mona Lott

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

Earlier, about 6:33 by my watch, I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to inspect the ownership card attached inside the front glass. By the toast I was in the East Gallery, outside the alcove; a disputed export record needed attention. An announcement is not an agreement.

#### IF MURDERER

I went inside the Star Bowl alcove to read the ownership wording fastened to the inside of the glass front. That was about 6:44; I checked my watch. An ownership dispute does not vanish when a label faces the other way. I delivered my request for the export records to Grant's salon.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## ACT III: METHOD

**Mona Lott**

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

## ACT III: METHOD

Mona Lott

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

I leaked the existence of the restitution talks to journalists. They were confidential, and I used that breach to put pressure on Grant. The bowl's disputed history is real; it has not become legal because someone put it in a case. My chosen weapon was publicity. It made me enemies in several countries.

### Evidence Table / discovery index

- |                                  |                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement                | 9. Education reallocation         |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988      | 10. Donor Salon camera            |
| 3. A warning left behind         | 11. Donation entry / 1989         |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY        | 12. Closing reveal / concept      |
| 5. Treatment finding             | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip         |
| 7. Auction result                | 15. Cancelled programme cue       |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux              | 16. Grant Larceny's toast         |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## ACCUSATIONS

Mona Lott

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### Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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## COMING CLEAN

Mona Lott

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### The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

#### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I leaked confidential restitution talks to journalists. My claim to inspect the ownership card attached inside the front glass was invented. I borrowed that detail from the abandoned cabinet proposal to conceal my preparations. At the toast I really was outside the alcove in the East Gallery, as I told you. That false errand covered my other misconduct; I did not poison Grant Larceny.

#### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

An announcement is not an agreement. Grant intended to make the Star Bowl a permanent Meridian holding. That would destroy months of restitution negotiations and humiliate the international partners I represent. He wanted an announcement before anybody could challenge his claim. I wanted him to stop. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*